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Generally organizations do not allow employees to avail leaves during notice period. However in certain circumstances, Garden Leave is granted to employees.



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Garden Leave

You may advise an employee to stay away from work during the notice period. This practice is known as Garden Leave. In this case, the employee is paid the salary and benefits. This leave is granted in two situations, when you are to:



a. Maintain confidentiality

In case an employee has access to confidential information and is planning to join the competition.

b. Support Employees

In case of involuntary exits, an employee may request to be on the rolls of the organization till the time employee finds another job.

In the End

As an HR expert, you must not take the exit of an employee personally. You should keep the doors open, as some of the employees would like to come back after experiencing the harsh reality of the world outside. The number of people joining back your organization conveys a positive message to potential candidates and existing employees. It creates a strong brand image. Make sure that you are not paying a huge premium for bringing the people back. Then the existing employees will get demotivated and your attrition will rise.

You also need to recognize that the separation process requires strong compliance and governance. A mishandled separation process pose a significant risk to the organization. You should be very particular in ensuring compliance, following governance and mitigating risks. We will discuss the compliance, governance and risk in the next section.

Separation is not the
end of a relationship.